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Employee Benefits Eligibility

Educational and synthetic policy corpus. Northstar Technologies Inc. is a fictional company created for an AI engineering project. All people, records, email addresses, examples, and operational data are synthetic. These documents are not legal advice and do not replace applicable law, benefit plan documents, signed employment agreements, or case-specific guidance from People Operations.

Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-BEN-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees of Northstar Technologies Inc.; actual coverage is governed by the applicable benefit plan documents and insurer records
Classification	Internal

BEN-1. Purpose

This policy explains general eligibility, enrollment timing, status changes, dependent coverage, continuation during leave, and escalation for Northstar-sponsored benefits. It does not summarize every plan term. When this policy conflicts with an insurer, retirement-plan, or other formal plan document, the formal plan document controls unless applicable law provides otherwise.

BEN-2. Employment categories

- **Regular Full-Time (RFT):** Normally scheduled for 30 or more hours per week.
- **Regular Part-Time (RPT):** Normally scheduled for 20-29 hours per week.
- **Temporary employee or intern:** Hired for a defined period or program and not designated RFT or RPT.
- **Contractor:** A non-employee providing services under a commercial agreement.

Eligibility is based on the category in the HR system, average scheduled hours where required by the plan, location, and any written employment terms.

BEN-3. General eligibility matrix

Benefit category	RFT	RPT	Temporary/intern	Contractor
Employee Assistance Program (EAP)	Eligible from start date	Eligible from start date	Eligible only if program terms include the category	Not eligible
Core medical, dental, and vision	Eligible, subject to waiting period and local plan	Eligible only when normally scheduled at least 25 hours/week and the local plan permits	Not eligible unless written terms say otherwise	Not eligible
Company-paid life and disability	Eligible where offered by local plan	Normally not eligible unless local plan or written terms say otherwise	Not eligible unless written terms say otherwise	Not eligible
Retirement or savings plan	Eligible when plan age/service rules are met	Eligible when plan age/service rules are met	Plan-specific	Not eligible through Northstar
Voluntary benefits	Plan-specific	Plan-specific	Plan-specific	Not eligible

Applicable law may require a different result. The HR system's `benefits_status` record is the operational source for an individual employee, but plan administrators make final coverage determinations.

BEN-4. Coverage start and waiting period

For an otherwise eligible employee, core insured coverage normally begins on the first day of the calendar month after the employee completes 30 calendar days of eligible service. Example: an eligible employee starting September 10 normally has coverage effective November 1.

When a plan or local law requires earlier coverage, that requirement applies. A rehire, transfer, or status change may have special rules and must be reviewed by People Operations.

BEN-5. Enrollment window

An employee must complete required enrollment or waiver elections within 31 calendar days after the eligibility notice. Failure to act may result in default coverage, employee-only coverage, or no optional coverage, depending on the plan.

After the initial window, an employee may normally change elections only during annual open enrollment or within 31 calendar days after a qualifying life event, such as marriage, divorce, birth, adoption, or loss of other coverage. Evidence may be required.

BEN-6. Dependents and beneficiaries

Eligible dependents are defined by the applicable plan. Employees are responsible for accurate dependent information and timely removal of a person who is no longer eligible. Knowingly enrolling an ineligible person may result in repayment, loss of coverage, corrective action, or insurer action.

Beneficiary designations should be reviewed after major life events. A beneficiary shown in the HR portal is not necessarily valid for every plan; employees must complete plan-specific forms when required.

BEN-7. Employee contributions and payroll deductions

Employee premiums and contributions are deducted from payroll when the plan permits. Employees must review pay statements and report an apparent error promptly. Missed deductions may be collected prospectively or through a reasonable repayment arrangement.

Northstar may change contribution levels during open enrollment or when a plan changes, subject to notice and applicable requirements.

BEN-8. Changes in hours, role, or location

A change in employment category, scheduled hours, legal entity, province, state, or country may change eligibility, plan options, cost, or coverage date. The employee and manager must notify People Operations before a planned change. People Operations will provide an eligibility decision based on the applicable plan.

Temporary work approved under **POL-INT-001** does not automatically change benefits. Extended assignments or permanent moves require a separate benefits review.

BEN-9. Benefits during leave

Coverage during statutory, medical, parental, personal, or other leave is determined by **POL-LEV-001**, applicable law, and plan terms. During some unpaid leaves, an employee may need to pay the employee share of premiums directly. Failure to pay after required notice may result in coverage ending where legally permitted.

Paid PTO alone does not interrupt eligibility.

BEN-10. Separation and continuation options

Coverage normally ends on the date or at the end of the month specified by the applicable plan and separation notice. People Operations provides information about any conversion, continuation, or portability option for which the employee may qualify. Deadlines are controlled by the plan or law and should be acted on promptly.

BEN-11. Privacy and access

Benefits information is Confidential. Managers should not request diagnoses, claim details, or dependent medical information. People Operations and plan administrators access only information necessary to administer eligibility, enrollment, contributions, leave, or accommodation processes.

The AI assistant may report a synthetic employee's eligibility or enrollment status from mock data, but it must not invent coverage, diagnose a condition, or make a final insurer determination.

BEN-12. Appeals, corrections, and escalation

An employee who believes a record is incorrect should submit a benefits case under **POL-HRC-001** and include the employee ID, plan, event date, expected status, and any relevant notice. People Operations will correct Northstar records when appropriate or direct the employee to the plan's formal appeal process.

An urgent loss of medication access or active treatment should be marked high priority, but a service target is not a guarantee of insurer approval.

BEN-13. Responsibilities

Employees make timely and accurate elections, review deductions, and report changes. Managers notify People Operations of approved status changes without seeking medical details. People Operations administers eligibility and notices. Payroll processes authorized deductions. Plan administrators decide claims and plan-specific coverage.

BEN-14. Examples

- An RFT employee who has completed the waiting period is generally eligible for core benefits, subject to enrollment and plan terms.
- An RPT employee scheduled for 22 hours per week receives the EAP and may qualify for retirement benefits, but does not ordinarily qualify for core insured benefits under this policy.
- An RPT employee scheduled for 27 hours may be eligible for core insured benefits if the local plan permits and the employee enrolls on time.
- A contractor is not eligible for employee benefits merely because the contractor works full-time hours on a project.

Related policies and records

- **POL-LEV-001 - Statutory, Medical, and Personal Leave**
- **POL-ONB-001 - New Employee Onboarding**
- **POL-HRC-001 - HR Case Management and Escalation**